FR-DC-SCROG-03

Showdown At Starmetal Hills

A Longsaddle Adventure



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A no-good band of outlaws up and robbed the Gambling Golem, snatching the coin lockbox and hightailing it into the wild, rocky stretch folks call the Starmetal Hills. Now, justice rides on the backs of ranchers, drifters, and any soul brave, or stubborn enough, to saddle up and track down the thieves.

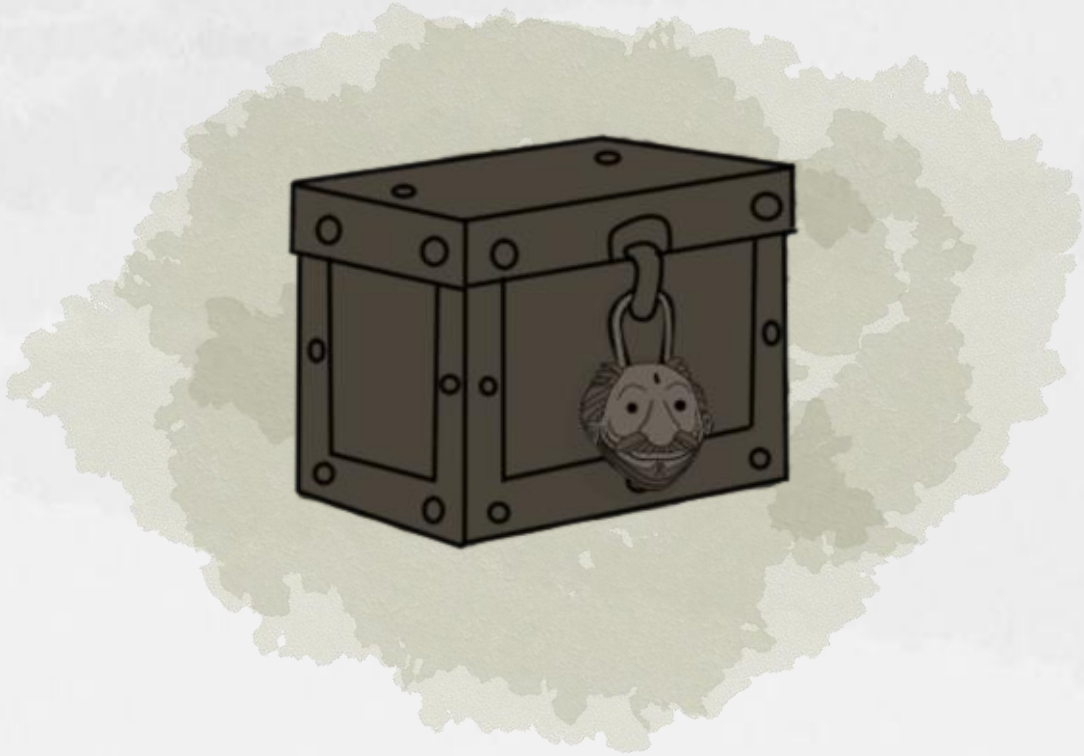
A One-Hour Adventure for 1st and 2nd Level Characters. Optimized for APL 1.
A Longsaddle Adventure

CONTENT WARNING: Frontier Justice, Risk of Animal Harm

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Adventure Primer

"A good man is a hammer in the hand of Tyr."
Miltiades of Phlan

Showdown At Starmetal Hills is designed for **three to seven 1st-2nd-level characters** and is optimized for five characters with an **average party level (APL) of 1.** Characters outside this level range cannot participate in this adventure. This adventure occurs in Longsaddle.

Background

THE GOGAN BROTHERS GANG, a slick-tongued pack of no-good, thieving, backstabbing, sweet-smiling jackalweres, has robbed the **GAMBLING GOLEM** in **LONGSADDLE**. Ordinarily, that would be a fool's errand.

Years ago, the Gogan boys tried something similar and got themselves caught and ran outta Longsaddle with their tails tucked. In response, the **HARPELLS**, a family of eccentric wizards and stalwart defenders of the frontier hamlet, wove powerful wards to alert them if any jackalwere ever came slinking back.

But them Gogans are wily. This time, they didn't show up themselves. Instead, they sent some nasty help, a pack of kenku drifters known as **THE LUSKAN CITY GANG.** Mean as snakes and twice as ornery. The Gogan Brothers convinced the avian outlaws that Longsaddle was easy pickings. The kenku agreed to the alliance, but they ain't planning on splitting the loot.

Them Luskan City birds strolled into the Gambling Golem in the morning and raised hell. By the time anyone could muster a response, the outlaws were gone, hightailing it toward the **STARMETAL HILLS** where the Gogan Brothers were waiting for them. Now the good folk of Longsaddle ain't about to let that stand. They are fixing to put together a posse made up of ranchers, goat herders, and a few adventurers. There is coin to recover and justice to serve.

Overview

The adventure begins with a **Call to Action** scene and has one main **Part.** The adventure takes approximately **1 hour** to play.

Call to Action. The posse arrives at a fork in the trail and decides to split up. Picking a path is the **Call to Action.**

Part 1. The Pursuit. Depending on which path the characters choose to follow, they lead to different problems with the outlaws. Recovering the stolen coin lockbox or bringing the outlaws to justice is the **Story Objective.**

Adventure Hook

Use these hooks to explain why the characters are in Longsaddle.

Longriders. The character has heard that Longsaddle is a place where fortunes are made. Out on these frontier lands, ranchers, farmers, and wizards are always looking to hire folks who can fend off monsters, cattle thieves, and the occasional band of marauding barbarians.

Longsaddler. The character is or was a resident of Longsaddle or the surrounding lands. They know the local faces, the Harpells' reputation, and just how weird things can get around these parts. They might be just as strange themselves and have been accepted as part of the community all the same.

Faction Agent. The character is working with one of the many factions of Faerûn, an adventuring society, or a guild. Either way, they are temporarily stationed in Longsaddle between missions, gathering information, maintaining a presence, or awaiting new orders.

Harpell Apprentice. The character is currently staying at Ivy Mansion as part of an apprenticeship. Under the tutelage of the Harpells, they've been learning spells, dodging experiments gone wrong, and helping contain magical accidents. When the Harpells need someone to handle a strange task or investigate a disturbance, it's usually the apprentices who get volunteered.

Gogan Brothers Gang Feud
At certain points in the adventure, the **Story Award** (**Gogan Brothers Gang Feud**) (from *FR-DC-SCROG-02 Bad Weather Over Longsaddle*) may influence the unfolding events. If none of the characters possess this story award, simply ignore any references to it.



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Call to Action

Estimated Duration. 15 minutes

Whether the characters are just passing through Longsaddle or tending to personal business, they find themselves swept up into a heap of local trouble. Maybe it's the promise of a reward. Could be they've got a do-gooder streak a mile wide.

One way or another, they have volunteered, more or less, and joined a posse led by Athena Blackpring (**scout**), a weathered human adventurer. The posse was assembled to track down a band of thieves who robbed the Gambling Golem and fled with the casino's coin lockbox.

Alongside Athena rides a band of five **commoners**, made up primarily of humans from Longsaddle. They are brave enough to join the ride, but no match for professional killers. Athena knows it. The characters are the only real talent she has, and if this posse has any chance of catching the thieves, it rides with them.

Mounts

The Gambling Golem has provided each member of the posse with a **riding horse** and a riding saddle on loan. Small characters are lent a puddlejumper (**giant frog**), and an exotic saddle**.** A puddlejumper is a hybrid of a horse and frog and has the front half of a horse and the back half of a giant frog, complete with springy legs and a damp, amphibian haunch.

Call to Action

Picking a path is the **Call to Action.**

The Starmetal Hills

Area Information

The hills have the following features.

Terrain. The ground is uneven and rocky, consisting of crumbling shale, scattered boulders, and hardened soil. Most of the area counts as difficult terrain.

Lighting. During daylight hours, the hilltops are bathed in bright light from the sun. In the valleys and narrow passes between hills, shadows stretch long, creating areas of dim light. As night approaches, the land settles into dim light under the glow of a bright moon. However, the valleys and passes fall into complete darkness.

Weather. It is late spring in the North. The hills are generally dry, with occasional light winds that carry dust and grit. Daytime temperatures average around 80°F (27°C), while nights grow chilly, dropping to approximately 40°F (4°C).

The posse has been following the tracks of the outlaws for three hours. Read aloud or paraphrase the following:

> The way ahead is rough, and the outlaws have a good head start, but spirits are high as the posse rides out under a wide, cloudless sky. Dust kicks up with every hoofbeat as the tracks wind into the Starmetal Hills, a jagged maze of rocky knolls, twisted gullies, and ancient ridgelines that run parallel to The Long Road. Though beautiful in a stark way, the land feels old and restless. Stars have fallen here before, leaving behind craters and rumors of strange minerals buried deep in the hills.
>
> The posse pulls up short as the tracker of the group, Athena, raises a gloved hand to signal a halt. The signs of movement are plain. Horse tracks veer west, while a lighter set of prints heads east on foot. Athena swings down from her saddle and moves ahead, crouching low to get a closer look at the tracks.

Creature Information

Athena Blackpring is a human adventurer that was chosen by the Harpells to lead the posse after the bandits.

Athena Blackpring

Neutral human (she/her) scout

Athena is a lean woman in her mid-50s, with wind-chapped skin, sharp eyes, and streaks of silver in her braided black hair. She wears a mix of gray and green leathers and wool. Her teeth are blackened from years of chewing tabac.

What They Want. Athena wants justice for Longsaddle.

Straight Shooter. Athena is blunt, sardonic, and not one for speeches or ceremony.

Athena studies the tracks and quickly realizes the group needs to investigate both sets. She suspects the thieves released the horses to mislead their pursuers but lacked the skill to properly cover the trail they left behind.

After a moment's thought, she spits in the dirt and signals the characters to approach. Athena knows they can't cover both trails with strength. One group will have to investigate the hoofprints, the other the footpath. She leaves the decision to the characters, trusting their judgment to pick the more promising lead. Read or paraphrase the following:

> "One trail shows boots. The other, hooves. Could be bait. Could be a split. Tracks are muddled but I cannot be in two places at once and I have green hands behind me. You lot have grit. I will take one trail with the locals. You take the other. Your call."

Once they choose, she'll take the posse along the other route. Athena squints at the sun and figures there's about eight hours of daylight left**.** She tells the characters to make camp when night falls and return to this spot after sunrise to regroup and share what they've found. The rest of the posse will wait here an hour before riding on to follow their trail.

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Though she warns them not to face the outlaws alone, she admits that they're the only capable hands she's got. If the chance to strike comes, they'll have to trust their gut.

What Athena Knows

- The posse are tracking down the ***Luskan City Gang***, six thieves on horseback.
- The thieves left Longsaddle this morning with a ***two-hour*** head start. The group's made up entirely of kenku, and a few of them are spellcasters.
- Athena doesn't know how much the thieves stole, only that the Gambling Golem's ***lockbox*** is secured with a magical lock.
- ***Three sets of boot prints head east***. Since they appear to be on foot, riders could catch up in about two hours, or faster with some risk to the mounts.
- ***Six sets of hoofprints break west.*** At a normal pace, the characters won't gain on them. Riding hard for an hour might close the distance, but the rough terrain could injure their mounts.

Characters can attempt to recall information about the Luskan City Gang by making a DC 15 Intelligence (History) check. On a success, they remember hearing stories about a band of kenku outlaws known for arson, murder, and causing trouble up and down the Sword Coast. Despite the name, none of them are actually from Luskan.



The Posse

Before the groups split, Athena tells the characters to take one of the other posse members with them. If something goes wrong and they don't make it back, she wants someone who can ride back to Longsaddle and report what happened. Let the players choose one of the posse members listed below.

- **Bertie.** A sun-leathered ranch hand who believes the heist was orchestrated by (a creature of your choice, such as doppelgangers, forest gnomes, yuan-ti, etc.). She frequently taps her temple and mutters, "Think about it," whenever someone questions her logic.
- **Vetty Ostever.** A broad-shouldered butcher who brought a meat cleaver. Vetty has an encyclopedic passion for recipes involving various monster parts, which she shares whether she asked or not.
- **Noir Nocturne.** A lank-haired, black-clad poet with smudged eyeliner and a deep sigh for every occasion. Most of his responses are a disinterested, "Whatever." His real name is Fenrick Sharnshield.
- **Quentin Emmert.** A cheerful oddball who can't hold a thought longer than six seconds. He is often giggling or getting distracted mid-sentence. It's all about good vibes, man.
- **Larry.** An overweight rancher that speaks in a fast, slurred mumble that's nearly impossible to understand. Everyone seems to know exactly what he means except the player characters. A *Comprehend Language* spell or telepathy can decipher his insightful words of wisdom.

The Bidderdoo

Unbeknownst to the group, the NPC chosen by the characters is secretly **werewolf** and a member of the **Bidderdoos**, a line of shapeshifters who have protected Longsaddle in secret since the time of Bidderdoo Harpell. They won't reveal their nature unless the situation becomes dire (such as the characters losing or being outnumbered). In combat, while in human form, the Bidderdoo only provides the Help action to assist the characters.

What They Want. They know the Gogan Brothers are behind the theft and intend to help take them down.

Comic Relief. The NPC's eccentric behavior might seem like an act, but it isn't. They are genuinely that odd.

Development

Once the characters choose a trail and select one of the locals to ride with them, Athena wishes them luck, then swings into the saddle. A sharp command follows, and the rest of the posse falls in behind her as she leads them down the opposite route. Proceed to **Part 1**.

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Part 1: The Pursuit

Estimated Duration. 45 minutes

The characters must decide which trail to follow, either the hoofprints leading west or the boot prints heading east. This choice sets the direction of the adventure and determines what encounters lie ahead. Once they choose a trail, they must also decide whether to press their mounts to catch up quickly or travel at a safer pace through the rugged terrain. Pushing their horses may help them close the distance, but it carries the risk of injuring their mounts before they reach the thieves.

Story Objective

To recover the stolen coin lockbox or bring the outlaws to justice is the **Story Objective.**

That's Some Fancy Riding

Read aloud or paraphrase the following:

> The Starmetal Hills roll out ahead like the spine of some long-dead beast, all broken ridgelines and sunbaked stone. Wind hisses through dry grass and thorny brush, stirring dust devils that dance across the trail. The sun glares down from a cloudless sky, already high and hot, with maybe eight hours of daylight left before the hills go dark.

Area Information

The hills have the same general features outlined in the Call to Action. Add the following features.

Visibility. During daylight, characters can see up to 2 miles unless terrain features such as rocks, ridgelines, or brush block their view. If a character climbs to the top of a high hill, they can see up to 40 miles in any direction. Flying creatures may be able to spot their quarry from above. The horses heading west are approximately 3 miles away, while the group on foot is about 2 miles out. Due to the distance, only vague figures or movement can be seen. The number of individuals or specific details remain unclear, and a flying creature cannot determine whether the horses are mounted or simply running loose unless they get closer.

Tracks. Following the tracks is fairly easy during the day. However, at night, limited visibility and uneven terrain make tracking more difficult. At night, a tracker can use the Search action to make a Wisdom (Survival) check against DC 15, with advantage due to the abundance of tracks. On a success, the tracker follows the trail. On a failure, the trail is lost, but the character can attempt to locate it again by carefully searching the area for one hour.

Time Limit

The characters are in pursuit of outlaws, and time is not on their side. The thieves have split into two groups in an effort to throw off pursuit. One group travel on horseback, moving fast across open land. The other slips away on foot, sticking to gullies, creek beds, and cover. Fortunately for the pursuers, the mounted outlaws ran into trouble and lost an hour of travel, while the ones on foot spent more time arguing than moving. The posse cannot follow both. The characters must decide which group to chase. The coin lockbox could be with either group. And if the characters spend too long deciding, they may lose both trails entirely.

Tracking Time

Here is a timeline of relevant events to help track the pursuit and determine when key encounters occur:

8:00 AM – The outlaws rob the Gambling Golem and flee Longsaddle, heading toward the Starmetal Hills.
10:00 AM – The posse departs Longsaddle in pursuit.
1:00 PM – The posse arrives at the point where the tracks split. One set of tracks lead into rough terrain on foot, while the other set of tracks is made by horses.
9:00 PM – Sundown. Visibility drops, and tracking becomes significantly harder without magical aid or proper light sources. Around this time, the outlaws begin to make camp.
3:00 AM (Optional) – The Gogan Brothers murder the outlaws and flee into the Starmetal Hills.
5:00 AM (Optional) – The Luskan City Gang mount their horses and continue south toward Triboar.
7:00 AM – The posse regroups to compare findings and plan the next steps in the pursuit.

As a Search action, a character can inspect the tracks and make a DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check. On a success, the character can confirm the same details Athena has already shared about the split in the trail and the outlaws' movements. If a character beats the DC by 5 or more, they notice something Athena missed: unusual tracks in the nearby brush. Three sets of prints begin as animal tracks before shifting into humanoid boot prints. Whoever they are, they're following the outlaws on foot.

A character may take the Study action and make a DC 13 Intelligence (Nature) check on the animal tracks. On a success, they identify the prints as belonging to a jackal. A character may make a DC 11 Intelligence (Arcana) check to recall that several creatures are capable of such transformations. Shapeshifters such as jackalweres and lycanthropes, certain fiends, druids, or even spellcasters using polymorph magic could all be responsible.

The NPC chosen by the characters to accompany them confirms that the tracks belong to jackalweres. They explain that these jackalweres are likely the Gogan Brothers Gang, a slippery crew of outlaws known up and down the Long Road. The gang isn't made up of blood kin, but they all call each other "brother" and run their outfit like a big, rowdy family. They're also made up entirely of jackalweres.

The characters are mounted on either a **riding horse** or a puddlejumper (**giant frog**).

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In difficult terrain, a riding horse travels at a fast pace of 4 miles per hour, a normal pace of 3 miles per hour, or a slow pace of 2 miles per hour. Puddlejumpers aren't affected by difficult terrain of the Starmetal Hills and have the same travel pace as a riding horse. The mounted outlaws move at a normal pace of 3 miles per hour but are only one hour ahead due to mishaps while trying to manage so many horses. The outlaws on foot move at a normal pace of 1.5 miles per hour but are two hours ahead. Both groups of outlaws stop to camp around 9:00 PM as night falls.

- At a normal pace, the mounted characters can catch up to the outlaws on foot within two hours. Reduce the time by one hour if they move at a fast pace or add four hours if they move at a slow pace.
- At a normal pace, the mounted characters arrive at the camp of the mounted outlaws within ten hours. Reduce the time by one hour if they move at a fast pace or add two hours if they move at a slow pace.
- If the characters are on foot (due to losing their mounts because of riding complications or choosing to go on foot), you can estimate that the characters arrive at the outlaw camps around 11:00 PM for the outlaws on foot, or around 1:00 AM for the outlaws on horseback. These estimates assume the characters are traveling at a normal pace. Reduce the time by one hour if they move at a fast pace or add two hours if they move at a slow pace.

Note that traveling at a fast pace imposes disadvantage on a traveler's Wisdom (Perception or Survival) and Dexterity (Stealth) checks. Traveling at a normal pace imposes disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks. Traveling at a slow pace grants advantage on Wisdom (Perception or Survival) checks.

If the characters decide to press their mounts to move faster (doubling their speed), they can reach the quarry within 1d10 + 30 minutes. Once a mount has been pushed to double its speed, it cannot be pushed again until it has completed a Short or Long Rest.

To navigate the terrain safely at high speed, each rider must attempt a DC 13 skill check. They may choose one of the following skills for the roll: Strength (Athletics), Intelligence (Investigation), Wisdom (Animal Handling), or Wisdom (Perception). The NPC posse member is assumed to succeed automatically. Any character who fails their check must roll on the Riding Complications table to determine what goes wrong during the ride.

TABLE 1.1 RIDING COMPLICATIONS

1d6	Complication
1	A mount slips on a patch of crumbling rock and takes 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage from the fall. The rider must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or be thrown from the saddle, taking 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage and falling prone.
2	A snake sunning on a rock sends the mount into a panic. The rider must succeed on a DC 13 Animal Handling check to calm the beast. On a failure, the rider is thrown off the mount, taking 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage and falling prone. The mount runs off in a panic. Characters can track it down with a DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check, but the search takes 1d4 x 10 minutes.
3	A mount trips on a rock, does a full front-flip, and somehow lands on its feet. The rider must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or be flung into a cactus, taking 5 (2d4) piercing damage.
4	The rider charges through a hidden burrow field, upsetting a swarm of furious groundhogs. The character must succeed on a DC 13 Animal Handling check or be swarmed. The mount takes 5 (2d4) piercing damage from a dozen tiny bites, and the rider's pants are either shredded beyond repair or torn clean off. The swarm stops attacking after a round and flees back into their burrows.
5	The rider's mount gets nervous and starts letting out a series of loud, noxious farts. The rider and the mount directly behind (chosen at random) must each make a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or suffer the poisoned condition for the next hour from the overwhelming stench. It's that bad.
6	The mount plunges into a collapsed sinkhole, ten feet wide and twenty feet deep. It takes 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage from the fall. The rider must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw to leap free. On a failure, they fall in as well, taking 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage and landing in a heap beside their mount.

THE LOCKBOX

It does not really matter which group the characters decide to chase. Coincidentally, or perhaps by the will of Tymora, the group they pursue just so happens to be the one carrying the stolen coin lockbox from the Gambling Golem.

The lockbox is protected by a *Lock of Trickery* imbued with the *Unbreakable* minor property. The only way to destroy the lock is with an adamantine weapon. The lockbox itself is not indestructible. It has 15 hit points and weighs 40 lbs. due to the coins inside. Inside there are 2,000 copper pieces, a tin harmonica (trinket), a bottle of snake oil (trinket), and a handful of crumpled IOUs, each scribbled with a name: the Slayer, Corvus Ravenwinter, Bertie, Kipper, Regis, Badmoon, and Larry.

Now, if the characters are feeling a bit crooked, they might hang onto that coin lockbox (and the contents inside). Their Bidderdoo companion doesn't care about the coin lockbox or what the characters intend to do with it. If the characters do keep the enchanted lock, they eventually find the key in Longsaddle after the adventure.

DEVELOPMENT

If the characters catch up to either group of outlaws before they make camp, proceed to **Encounter A.** If the characters arrive at the camp of the outlaws, proceed to **Encounter B.**

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Encounter A. Outlaw Pursuit

If the characters catch up with either group of outlaws on the move, then run this encounter. Read or paraphrase the following:

> The trail winds between two steep hills. Jagged rocks and clusters of scrub line the uneven slope. Large boulders jut from the hillside, creating short pockets of shadow along the path.

Area Information

This location has the following features.

Terrain. The trail leads through the hills, where the slope rises sharply on all sides.

Slopes. All slopes count as difficult terrain.

Obstacles. The surrounding terrain is dotted with natural cover. Large boulders and scattered stone outcroppings offer protection to anyone approaching the ridge. A creature behind one of these features may gain cover, depending on their position.

Lighting. During daylight hours, the area is bathed in bright light from the sun.

Map. Use **map 3.1 (Appendix 1)** for this encounter.

Development

If the characters followed the mounted group, proceed to **The Mounted Outlaws**. If they followed the group on foot, proceed to **The Outlaws on Foot**.

The Mounted Outlaws

The adventurers come upon five **riding horses** grazing nervously on the hillside. One horse is missing, lost earlier when an outlaw had a mishap with a cantankerous earth elemental that did not take kindly to being stepped on. The elemental killed both the horse and its rider.

A **raven** circling overhead is actually a familiar. It serves as an aerial reconnaissance for its **kenku** master, keeping watch from about 200 feet in the air. If the raven is attacked and survives, it immediately takes the Dodge action and attempts to fly away. If the raven is killed, it cannot warn its master. As a result, the mounted outlaws are caught off guard and are easily surprised when the characters arrive.

The Luskan City outlaws (**kenku**) are hiding nearby, warned by the raven familiar that the characters are close. They have taken cover behind rocky outcroppings and plan to ambush the party as soon as they come within range of their ranged attacks. Any character with a Passive Perception of 14 or higher notices movement behind the rocks and is not surprised.

If the characters killed the raven familiar, the outlaws have dismounted to water their horses and unaware of the characters approach. The characters can choose to ambush the outlaws, who have a Passive Perception of 15. On initiative count 11, the outlaws' horses panic and flee into the hills.

Adjusting the Scene

Here are some suggestions for adjusting this scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove one **kenku.**
- **Weak.** Remove one **kenku.**
- **Average.** Five **kenku.**
- **Strong.** Add one kenku wizard **(pirate deck wizard).**
- **Very Strong.** Add another kenku wizard **(pirate deck wizard**).

The Bidderdoo

The Bidderdoo won't reveal their nature unless the situation becomes dire (such as the characters losing or being outnumbered). In combat, while in human form, the Bidderdoo only provides the Help action to assist the characters.

Adjusting the Adventure

If they are following the horse tracks it is possible for the characters to press their mounts to catch the mounted outlaws, then use the outlaws' horses to pursue the second group. However, the only way this plan succeeds is if the characters press the outlaw horses to double their speed for one hour, allowing them to eventually catch up with the outlaws on foot.

This method allows the characters to chase down both groups within the same session, although it may stretch the adventure session beyond one hour.

The other members of the posse won't be of any help. Athena is preoccupied with tracking down missing posse members who wandered off into the Starmetal Hills and got themselves lost.

If the characters choose to pursue and defeat both groups, only the first group they confront carries any treasure. The coin lockbox is also in the possession of that first group.

The Outlaws on Foot

If the characters were tracking the outlaws on foot**,** they find the Luskan City outlaws (**kenku**) and the **jackalweres**, the latter in their human forms. The two groups are locked in a heated argument over the coin lockbox. The Gogan Brothers want to force it open but worry that breaking the lockbox might damage whatever valuables lie inside. The Luskan City outlaws, unwilling to hand it over, insist on keeping the lockbox until they can discover a magical way to unlock it. They have a passive Perception of 15, but characters attempting to approach may do so with advantage on their Stealth checks.

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ADJUSTING THE SCENE
Here are some suggestions for adjusting this scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove one **kenku.**
- **Weak.** Remove one **kenku** and one **jackalwere.**
- **Average.** Three **kenku,** two **jackalwere.**
- **Strong.** Add one **jackalwere.**
- **Very Strong.** Add one giant jackal **(giant hyena).**

THE BIDDERDOO
The Bidderdoo won't reveal their nature unless the situation becomes dire (such as the characters losing or being outnumbered). In combat, while in human form, the Bidderdoo only provides the Help action to assist the characters.

GOGAN BROTHERS GANG FEUD
Any character with the **Story Award** (**Gogan Brothers Gang Feud**) is immediately recognized by the jackalweres as an enemy of their gang. The shapeshifters prioritize targeting these characters first.

OUTLAW NAMES SUGGESTIONS
Jackalwere: Bonnie Red Smoke, Delgrave the Hook, Big Iron Crowe, Jedidiah, Cassidy Six-Fingers, Maybelle Witch-Eye, Pearl the Grin, or Ezekiel Harrow
Kenku: Cough, Snap, Clang, Hell, Old Timer, Click Click Click, Witch Eye, Hush, Tink Tink, Scratch, Tom, or Rusty

TREASURE

The treasure for both encounters is the same. Characters that search the bodies of the outlaws find the following: a ten-gallon hat (trinket), a very confused toad (see sidebar), a pair of fancy snakeskin boots (trinket), and a colorful thin art book titled *Billy the Kid versus Strahd*, filled with pulpy illustrations (trinket). Rounding out the haul is twelve different rabbit foot charms; each dyed a different color (trinkets).

BATTLETOAD BILL
It is an unsavory pastime in Longsaddle, but toads are often used in animal fighting sports. The toad the characters recovered from the outlaws is no ordinary critter. It is a retired champion brawler known as Battletoad Bill, now freed from that cruel business. If the characters choose to keep the toad and take the time to care for it properly, they gain a loyal pet and an unlikely companion. The characters receive the **Story Award: Battletoad.**

DEVELOPMENT

Once the characters have defeated the band of outlaws and retrieved the coin lockbox, they may proceed to **Conclusion.** If any jackalweres are still alive, go to **The Protector** in **Encounter B**.





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Encounter B. Outlaw Camp

If the characters arrive at an outlaw camp, then run this encounter. Characters tracking the outlaws on foot arrive on top of the ridge. Characters tracking the mounted outlaws arrive at the base of the hollow.

Area Information

This location has the following features.

Terrain. The ground in the hollow is rocky but remains passable. It is mostly composed of hardened soil and stone.

Ridge. One side of the hollow rises sharply into a ridge, approximately 50 feet high. The slope is steep and broken, with loose shale, jutting rocks, and patches of dry brush. Characters can attempt to climb it with a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check and treat it as difficult terrain. On a failed check, the character either gains no progress or falls 10 feet, taking 2 (1d4) bludgeoning damage (DM's choice). Creatures on the ridge benefit from three-quarters cover from below unless they fully expose themselves.

Alternatively, a longer but safer trail winds around the far side of the ridge and up to the summit. This switchback path takes about 5 minutes on foot or 2 minutes mounted and does not require a check, though it leaves travelers exposed while ascending.

Obstacles. The surrounding terrain is dotted with natural cover. Large boulders and scattered stone outcroppings offer protection to anyone approaching the ridge. A creature behind one of these features gains cover depending on their position.

Lighting. At night, it is dim light conditions due to the bright moon overhead.

Map. Use **map 3.2 (Appendix 1)** for this encounter.

Development

If the characters followed the mounted group, proceed to **The Mounted Outlaws**. If they followed the group on foot, proceed to **The Outlaws on Foot**. Only one of the outlaw groups is in the camp, the other group has travelled in a different direction to meet up later.

The Mounted Outlaws

The mounted outlaws (**kenku**) have made their camp atop the ridge, with three **riding horses** tethered nearby. A character with a passive Perception of 14 or higher can spot the faint glow of their campfire, which is kept low and shielded behind rocks. The outlaws have released their extra horses into the wild to lighten their load and reduce noise. Their plan is to rest overnight and continue south toward Triboar by morning, hoping to stay ahead of any pursuit. The **raven** familiar is asleep on top of the lockbox. The outlaws take turns keeping watch throughout the night; the one on watch has a passive Perception of 15.

If the characters approach without using Stealth, the outlaw on watch alerts their companions, and the outlaws immediately prepare to ambush the intruders. Any character with a passive Perception of 14 or higher notices movement along the ridge and is not surprised if combat begins. On Initiative count 11, the outlaws' horses panic and flee into the hills. They are lost and cannot be recovered.

Adjusting the Scene

Here are some suggestions for adjusting this scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove one **kenku.**
- **Weak.** Remove one **kenku.**
- **Average.** Five **kenku,** one **raven.**
- **Strong.** Add a kenku wizard **(pirate deck wizard).**
- **Very Strong.** Add another kenku wizard **(pirate deck wizard).**

The Bidderdoo

The Bidderdoo won't reveal their nature unless the situation becomes dire (such as the characters losing or being outnumbered). In combat, while in human form, the Bidderdoo only provides the Help action to assist the characters.

The Outlaws on Foot

If the characters are tracking the outlaws on foot**,** they eventually arrive on the ridge overlooking the hollow. It is currently occupied by the Luskan City outlaws (**kenku**) and **jackalweres**, the latter in their hybrid forms. The outlaws have made their camp at the bottom of the ridge, keeping a low burning fire behind a large rock. Three Luskan City outlaws (**kenku**) are fast asleep, thanks to the jackalweres' Sleep Gaze ability. The Gogan Brothers are currently going through the Luskan City Gang's haul from the Gambling Golem heist. They have a passive Perception of 14. The jackalweres don't wake up the outlaws during combat. Any outlaw who awakens will attempt to flee.

Adjusting the Scene

Here are some suggestions for adjusting this scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove one **jackalwere.**
- **Weak.** Remove one **jackalwere.**
- **Average.** Three **jackalweres.**
- **Strong.** Add one giant jackal **(giant hyena).**
- **Very Strong.** Add another giant jackal **(giant hyena).**

Gogan Brothers Gang Feud

As detailed previously, any character with the **Story Award** (**Gogan Brothers Gang Feud**) is recognized by the jackalweres. See tactics on page 9.

The Bidderdoo

The Bidderdoo won't reveal their nature unless the situation becomes dire (such as the characters losing or being outnumbered). In combat, while in human form, the Bidderdoo only provides the Help action to assist the characters.

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Treasure

As detailed previously in **Encounter A.**

Development

With the outlaws defeated and the coin lockbox recovered, proceed to the **Conclusion.** If any jackalweres are still alive, go to **The Protector.**

The Protector

If any jackalweres remain alive, the characters' Bidderdoo companion reveals their true nature. Read or paraphrase the following:

> Your companion stumbles back, breathing hard, their form trembling. A low growl escapes their throat as their posture shifts, shoulders bunching and spine arching. There is the sound of bones popping and reshaping. Fur tears through skin as their clothing splits apart, falling in rags at their feet. In a matter of moments, the person who traveled with you is no longer standing there. In their place is a massive wolf creature standing on two legs.



Unless the characters intervene, the werewolf immediately moves to kill the remaining jackalwere. They growl that the fiend must be destroyed before it harms anyone else. If questioned, the werewolf says they mean the party no harm and identifies themself as a member of the Bidderdoo pack.

Characters can attempt a DC 12 Intelligence (History) check to recall information about the Bidderdoos. On a success, they remember local stories of a strange lineage said to descend from the archmage Bidderdoo Harpell. These tales are conflicting. Some say the Bidderdoos are cursed and follow Malar, the god of predators and wild savagery. Others say they are protectors who use their curse to hunt down greater evils and keep Longsaddle safe. The people of Longsaddle have mixed feelings towards the werefolk. Some respect the Bidderdoos, but many fear or hate them.

The Bidderdoo argues that the jackalwere should not be allowed to live. If the characters refuse to allow the killing, the werewolf growls, shoulders tense but ultimately backs down. They ask the party to keep their lycanthropy a secret and then vanish into the hills.

If the characters allow the Bidderdoo to destroy the jackalwere, the werewolf thanks them afterwards before shifting back into their humanoid form. The transformation leaves them shivering and half-naked, their clothes ruined and scattered. They quickly ask the characters to keep their secret, trusting them with the truth. And for some spare clothes.

Once this development is done, proceed to the **Conclusion** of the adventure.

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Conclusion

There are a few possible endings to this adventure, depending on which path they take.

In Memory of the Dearly Departed

If the characters chose to go after the outlaws on horseback, they hear that the posse ran smack into a fight between the Gogan Brothers and the Luskan City Gang. Turns out the Luskan City Gang pulled a fast one, passing the coin lockbox off to their riders before things got ugly. The outlaws got themselves wiped out, but so did the posse. Only Athena made it out, and now she's nursing a powerful thirst for revenge against those no good, backstabbing, shape-changing curs known as the Gogan Brothers. A funeral's held for the fallen with most of the folk in Longsaddle attending.

Ain't Dead Yet

If the characters decided to go after the outlaws on foot, they learn that the posse found the horses but were pinned down by snipers. Athena slipped away on her own and took out the outlaws while they were too busy trading shots with her team. Luckily, everyone made it out alive and now has a story worth telling. Characters gain the **Story Award: Gogan Brothers Gang Feud.**

Frontier Justice

Any surviving outlaw captured and brought back to Longsaddle is paraded through the streets toward the Market Podium. A crowd gathers as two archmages of the Harpell family arrive to pass judgment. According to the customs of Longsaddle, convicted criminals are *true polymorphed* into a harmless critter. In this case, a rabbit. These rabbits are then gathered and transported to the islet at the center of Pavlel Lake, where they join others who have been sentenced to begin new lives in their transformed state. Any surviving jackalwere, however, is not granted this fate.

The Harpells reserve a different form of justice for the Gogan Brothers. Execution by fireball.

Well Earned Rewards

If the characters bring back the coin lockbox (contents and magic lock), the proprietor of the Gambling Golem is mighty pleased to see it returned. The characters get 25 gold pieces for doing the right thing.

If the characters decide to keep the contents of the coin lockbox and the enchanted lock for themselves, well… Athena is none too happy to hear the coin lockbox was never found. She gives the party a long look, quiet and sharp, but says nothing for the time being.

Justice is Served

If the characters managed to take out both groups of outlaws, word of their feat spreads like wildfire across the Long Road about how a ragtag posse ran down the Luskan City Gang and the Gogan Brothers in one fell swoop. Athena Blackpring, beaming with pride, calls it one of the finest outlaw reckonings she's ever seen. She insists the characters lead the ride into town. The folk in Longsaddle throw a celebration for the characters and the other members of the posse at the Horn and Hoof tavern. Characters gain the **rewards** detailed in *Ain't Dead Yet*.

Bidderdoo Secrets

If the characters eliminated the Gogan Brothers or allowed their Bidderdoo companion to destroy the jackalwere, and kept the Bidderdoo's lycanthropy a secret, the Bidderdoo is grateful and rewards the party. The next day, each character receives a gift: a *silvered weapon (light crossbow)* imbued with the *sentinel* minor property.

If the characters reveal the Bidderdoo's true nature to the people of Longsaddle, the consequences are swift and unforgiving. Viewed with fear by their neighbors and abandoned by former friends, the Bidderdoo posse member quietly gathers their belongings and leaves Longsaddle behind. They disappear into the countryside to join the more feral pack of werewolves roaming the wilds.

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REWARDS

At the **end of the session**, the characters receive rewards based upon their accomplishments.

CHARACTER REWARDS

The characters earn the following rewards:

ADVANCEMENT

A character participating in this adventure gains one level.

GOLD

If found during the adventure the following items are converted to gold and added to any coins found during the adventure. The gold is split among the party members. If someone wants to keep an item in particular that character can either take it as part of their share, or pay for it with their own gold. Mundane items are not duplicated nor included in this.

Note that the characters gain either the Gambling Golem Reward or the Coin Lockbox's contents.

Item	Gold Value
Gambling Golem Reward	25 gp
Coin Lockbox's Contents	2,000 cp (20 gp)
Maximum	25 gp

MAGIC ITEM(S)

If found during the adventure, the characters can keep the following magic items; these items are described in Appendix 2:

- Lock of Trickery
- Silvered Weapon (Light Crossbow)

STORY AWARD(S)

- Gogan Brothers Gang Feud
- Battletoad

These awards are described in Appendix 2.

DUNGEON MASTER REWARDS

For running this adventure, you earn a DM Reward. See the Adventurers League Dungeon Master's Guide for more information.

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Creature Statistics

The following creatures appear in this adventure.

Commoner

Medium or Small Humanoid, Neutral
Armor Class 10
Hit Points 4 (1d8)
Speed 30 ft.
Initiative +0 (10)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +0, Dex +0, Con +0, Int +0, Wis +0, Cha +0
Senses passive Perception 10
Languages Common
Challenge 0 (10 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2
Gear Club

Training. The commoner has proficiency in one skill of the DM's choice and has Advantage whenever it makes an ability check using that skill.

Actions

Club. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) Bludgeoning damage.

Giant Frog (Puddlejumper)

Medium Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 11
Hit Points 18 (4d8)
Speed 30 ft., Swim 30 ft.
Initiative +1 (11)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)	2 (-4)	10 (+0)	3 (-4)

Saving Throws Str +1, Dex +1, Con +0, Int -4, Wis +0, Cha -4
Skills Perception +2, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 30 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages None
Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Amphibious. The frog can breathe air and water.

Standing Leap. The frog's Long Jump is up to 20 feet and its High Jump is up to 10 feet with or without a running start.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* (1d6+2) Piercing damage. If the target is a Medium or smaller creature, it has the Grappled condition (escape DC 11).

Swallow. The frog swallows a Small or smaller target it is grappling. While swallowed, the target isn't Grappled but has the Blinded and Restrained conditions, and it has Total Cover against attacks and other effects outside the frog. While swallowing the target, the frog can't use Bite, and if the frog dies, the swallowed target is no longer Restrained and can escape from the corpse using 5 feet of movement, exiting with the Prone condition. At the end of the frog's next turn, the swallowed target takes 5 (2d4) Acid damage. If that damage doesn't kill it, the frog disgorges it, causing it to exit Prone.

Puddlejumper
Puddlejumpers don't use the Swallow ability.

Giant Hyena (Giant Jackal)

Large Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 12
Hit Points 45 (6d10+12)
Speed 50 ft.
Initiative +2 (12)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	2 (-4)	12 (+1)	7 (-2)

Saving Throws Str +3, Dex +2, Con +2, Int -4, Wis -1, Cha -2
Skills Perception +3
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages None
Challenge 1 (200 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6+3) Piercing damage.

Reactions

Rampage (1/Day). Immediately after dealing damage to a creature that was already Bloodied, the hyena can move up to half its Speed, and it makes one Bite attack.

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KENKU

Medium Monstrosity, Neutral
Armor Class 13
Hit Points 13 (3d8)
Speed 30 ft.
Initiative +3 (13)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +0, Dex +3, Con +0, Int +0, Wis +0, Cha +0
Skills Deception +4, Perception +2, Stealth +5
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages Common, Primordial (Auran)
Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Mimicry. The kenku can mimic any sounds it has heard, including voices. A creature that hears the sounds can tell they are imitations with a successful DC 14 Wisdom (Insight) check.

ACTIONS

Shadow Blade (Melee). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6+3) Necrotic damage.

Shadow Blade (Ranged). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6+3) Necrotic Damage. *Hit or Miss: The* blade magically returns to the kenku's hand immediately.

BONUS ACTIONS

Eldritch Lantern (Recharge 4-6). The kenku casts *Faerie Fire*, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 10).

THE LUSKAN CITY GANG
The kenku's alignment is neutral evil.

JACKALWERE

Small Fiend, Chaotic Evil
Armor Class 12
Hit Points 18 (4d6+4)
Speed 40 ft.
Initiative +2 (12)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +0, Dex +2, Con +1, Int +1, Wis +0, Cha +0
Skills Deception +4, Perception +4, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 90 ft., passive Perception 14
Languages Common
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Pack Tactics. The jackalwere has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the jackalwere's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The jackalwere makes two Rend or Slam attacks.

Rend (Jackal or Hybrid Form Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* (1d6 + 2) Piercing damage.

Slam (Human or Hybrid Form Only). Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* (1d4 + 2) Bludgeoning damage.

Sleep Gaze (Recharge 5–6). Wisdom Saving Throw: DC 10, one creature the jackalwere can see within 30 feet (Constructs and Undead succeed automatically). Failure: The target has the Unconscious condition for 10 minutes or until it takes damage or a creature within 5 feet of it takes an action to wake it. Success: The target is immune to this jackalwere's Sleep Gaze for 24 hours.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shape-Shift. The jackalwere shape-shifts into a Medium human or a Medium jackal humanoid hybrid, or it returns to its true form (that of a Small jackal). Other than size, its game statistics are the same in each form. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying isn't transformed.

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Pirate Deck Wizard (Kenku Wizard)

Medium Humanoid (kenku), Any Alignment
Armor Class 12 (15 with mage armor)
Hit Points 32 (5d8+10)
Speed 30 ft.
Initiative +2 (12)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (-3)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +0, Dex +2, Con +2, Int +3, Wis +1, Cha +0
Skills Arcana +5, Perception +3
Senses passive Perception 13
Languages Any one language (usually Common)
Challenge 1 (200 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Sea Legs. The deck wizard has advantage on ability checks and saving throws to resist being knocked prone.

Spellcasting. The deck wizard is a 4th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). It has the following wizard spells prepared:
Cantrips (at will): friends, mage hand, prestidigitation, ray of frost
1st level (4 slots): disguise self, fog cloud, mage armor, witch bolt
2nd level (3 slots): gust of wind, Melf's acid arrow, misty step

Actions

Quarterstaff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) Bludgeoning damage.

Kenku Wizard
Change the creature type to Monstrosity. Their alignment is neutral evil. None of the kenku wizards have spellbooks in their possessions. Replace ray of frost with fire bolt, disguise self with feather fall, and Melf's acid arrow with web.

Raven

Tiny Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 12
Hit Points 2 (1d4)
Speed 10 ft., Fly 50 ft.
Initiative +2 (12)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
2 (-4)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)	13 (+1)	6 (-2)

Saving Throws Str -4, Dex +2, Con +0, Int -3, Wis +1, Cha -2
Skills Perception +3
Senses passive Perception 13
Languages None
Challenge 0 (10 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Mimicry. The raven can mimic simple sounds it has heard, such as a whisper or chitter. A hearer can discern the sounds are imitations with a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Insight) check.

Actions

Beak. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 (1d1) Piercing damage.

Riding Horse

Large Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 11
Hit Points 13 (2d10+2)
Speed 60 ft.
Initiative +1 (11)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	2 (-4)	11 (+0)	7 (-2)

Saving Throws Str +3, Dex +1, Con +1, Int -4, Wis +0, Cha -2
Senses passive Perception 10
Languages None
Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Actions

Hooves. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8+3) Bludgeoning damage.

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SCOUT

Medium Humanoid, Neutral
Armor Class 13
Hit Points 16 (3d8+3)
Speed 30 ft.
Initiative +2 (12)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +0, Dex +2, Con +1, Int +0, Wis +1, Cha +0
Skills Nature +4, Perception +5, Stealth +6, Survival +5
Senses passive Perception 15
Languages Common plus one other language
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2
Gear Leather Armor, Longbow, Shortsword

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The scout makes two attacks, using Shortsword or Longbow in any combination.

Shortsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 +2) Piercing damage.

Longbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 150/600 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8+2) Piercing damage.

WEREWOLF (BIDDERDOO)

Medium Monstrosity (Lycanthrope), Chaotic Evil
Armor Class 15
Hit Points 71 (11d8+22)
Speed 30 ft., Walk 40 ft. (wolf form only)
Initiative +4 (14)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +3, Dex +2, Con +2, Int +0, Wis +0, Cha +0
Skills Perception +4, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14
Languages Common (can't speak in wolf form)
Challenge 3 (700 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +2

Pack Tactics. The werewolf has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the werewolf's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The werewolf makes two attacks, using Scratch or Longbow in any combination. It can replace one attack with a Bite attack.

Bite (Wolf or Hybrid Form Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (2d8+3) Piercing damage. If the target is a Humanoid, it is subjected to the following effect. Constitution Saving Throw: DC 12. Failure: The target is cursed. If the cursed target drops to 0 Hit Points, it instead becomes a Werewolf under the DM's control and has 10 Hit Points. Success: The target is immune to this werewolf's curse for 24 hours.

Scratch. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6+3) Slashing damage.

Longbow (Humanoid or Hybrid Form Only). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 150/600 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d8+2) Piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shape-Shift. The werewolf shape-shifts into a Large wolf-humanoid hybrid or a Medium wolf, or it returns to its true humanoid form. Its game statistics, other than its size, are the same in each form. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying isn't transformed.

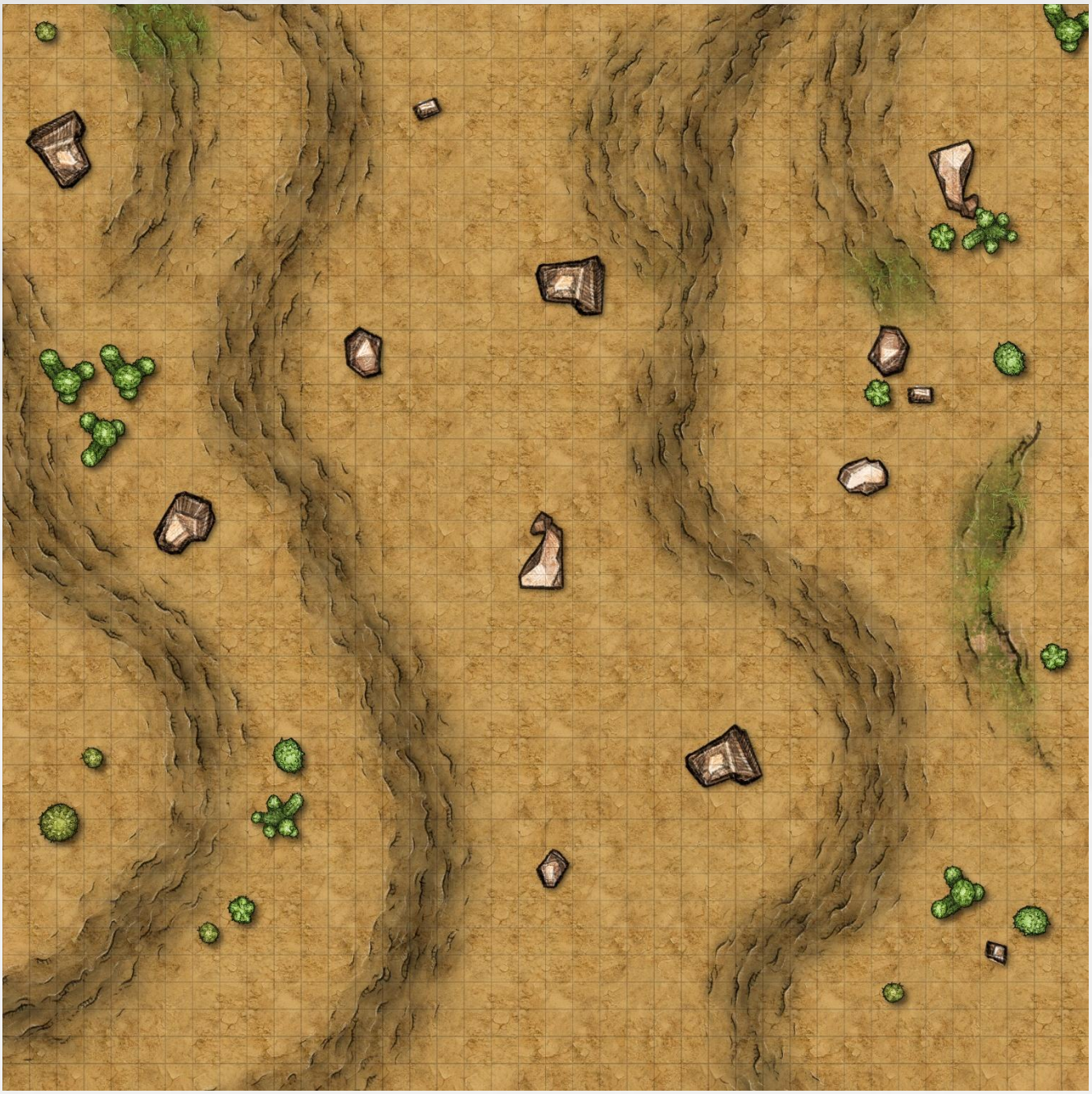
BIDDERDOO
Bidderdoo's alignment is chaotic good.

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Appendix 1. Maps

Map 3.1 – Outlaw Pursuit

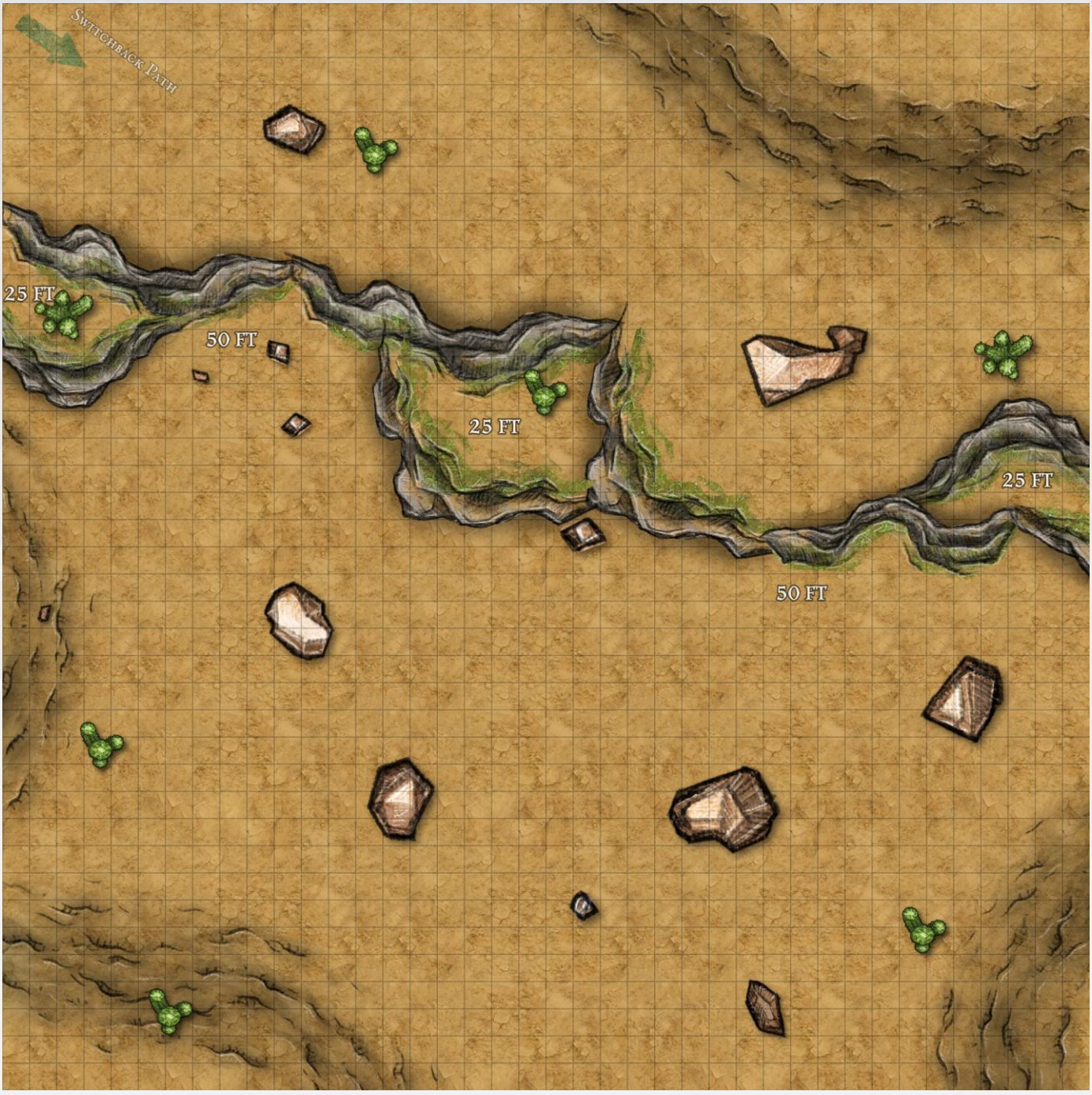
Each square is 5 feet.



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Map 3.2 – Outlaw Camp

Each square is 5 feet.



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Appendix 2: Character Rewards

During the adventure, the characters may discover magic items or earn story awards. At the end of the session, award each character only the magic items or story awards they earned. It's suggested that you print enough copies of this page to hand out to each player, crossing out any rewards not received during the session.

Lockbox of Trickery

Wondrous Item, Common

This lock appears to be an ordinary Lock (of the type described in chapter 6 of the Player's Handbook) and comes with a single key. The tumblers in this lock magically adjust to thwart burglars. Dexterity checks made to pick the lock have Disadvantage.

Unbreakable. The item can't be broken. Special means must be used to destroy it.

Shaped like a miniature, bearded wizard with a crooked grin, this enchanted lock seems almost pleased with itself. Only an adamantine weapon can destroy the lock and wipe the smirk off its face.

Silvered Weapon (Light Crossbow) "Jackal Slayer"

Weapon (Any Simple or Martial), Common

An alchemical process has bonded silver to this magic weapon. When you score a Critical Hit with it against a creature that is shape-shifted, the weapon deals one additional die of damage.

Sentinel. The DM chooses a kind of creature, such as mind flayers or trolls. This item glows faintly when such creatures are within 120 feet of it (**jackalwere**).

Crafted by the Harpell wizards, this finely made silvered light crossbow bears the nickname "Jackal Slayer" etched into the stock in flowing script.

Story Awards

Gogan Brothers Gang Feud

You done riled up the Gogan Brothers, a mean pack of jackalwere outlaws with slick smiles and murderous intent. Whatever it was you did, they took it real personal.

Battletoad

You now have a pet toad, known as Battletoad Bill, a retired champion fighting toad. Battletoad Bill is a broad-shouldered, warty green bruiser no bigger than a teacup. A silver scar slashes across one milky, dead eye, a reminder of his brawling days. Though typically noncombative, Battletoad Bill is a suitable target for the *find familiar* spell and uses the **frog**' stat block from the Monster Manual (2024), should you be able to cast it.



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Appendix 3. Dungeon Master Tips

To DM an adventure, you must have 3 to 7 players - each with their own character within the adventure's level range (see Adventure Primer). Characters playing in a hardcover adventure may continue to play too, but if they play a different hardcover adventure, they can't return to the first if they level beyond its level range.

New to D&D Adventurers League?

http://dnd.wizards.com/playevents/organized-play

https://yawningportal.dnd.wizards.com/

https://discord.gg/dnd

Preparing the Adventure

Before you start play, consider the following:

- Read through the adventure, taking notes of anything you'd like to highlight or remind yourself of while running the adventure, such as a way you'd like to portray an NPC or a tactic you'd like to use in a combat. Familiarize yourself with the adventure's appendices and handouts.
- Gather any resources you'd like to use to aid you in running this adventure - such as notecards, a DM screen, miniatures, and battlemaps.
- Ask the players to provide you with relevant character information, such as name, race, class, and level; passive Perception score, and anything the adventures specifies as notable (such as backgrounds, traits, and flaws).

Players can play an adventure they previously played as a player or Dungeon Master but may only play it once with a given character. Ensure each player has their character's adventure logsheet (if not, get one from the organizer) with their starting values for level, magic items, gold and downtime days. These are updated at the conclusion of the session. The adventure information and your information are added at the end of the adventure session - whether they completed the adventure or not.

Each player is responsible for maintaining an accurate logsheet. If you've time, you can do a quick scan of a player's character sheet to ensure nothing looks out of order. If you see magic items of very high rarities or strange arrays of ability scores, you can ask players to provide documentation for the irregularities. If they cannot, feel free to restrict item use or ask them to use a standard ability score array.

Point players to the *D&D Adventurers League Players Guide* for reference. If players wish to spend downtime days and it's the beginning of an adventure or episode, they can declare their activity and spend the days now, or they can do so at the end of the adventure or episode. Players should select their characters' spells and other daily options prior to the start of the adventure, unless the adventure specifies otherwise. Feel free to reread the adventure description to help give players hints about what they might face.

Adjusting This Adventure

To determine whether you should consider adjusting the adventure, add up the total levels of all the characters and divide the result by the number of characters (rounding .5 or greater up; .4 or less down). This is the group's average party level (APL). To approximate the **party strength** for the adventure, consult the table below.

Determining Party Strength

Party Composition	Party Strength
3–4 characters, APL less than	Very Weak
3–4 characters, APL equivalent	Weak
3–4 characters, APL greater than	Average
5 characters, APL less than	Weak
5 characters, APL equivalent	Average
5 characters, APL greater than	Strong
6–7 characters, APL less than	Average
6–7 characters, APL equivalent	Strong
6–7 characters, APL greater than	Very Strong

Safety Tools

Safety tools ensure that players aren't pushed beyond their comfort levels. They let your players know that you want them to have a positive experience. Some common safety tools are provided below - each with a summary of how they work. Make sure you discuss them with your players before the game.

There are a broad range of safety tools available for you and your players online, but for more information reach out to your Event Organizer or to community@dndadventurersleague.org.

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